

Esteban Garcia Taquez

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Chicago

Aug. 2023 – May 2027

B.S. Computer Science, Concentration in Software Engineering; Minor in Mathematics

Chicago, IL

Coursework: Computer Algorithms, Data Structures, Systems Programming, Probability & Statistics, Cryptography, Applied Linear Algebra, Database Systems, Machine Organization, Data and AI

DeVry University Advantage Academy

Aug. 2021 – May 2023

Associate in Business Administration, 4.0 GPA (earned concurrently with high school)

Chicago, IL

Coursework: Financial Accounting, Budgeting & Forecasting, Business Statistics, Operations Management, Business Ethics

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern (Technology Intern Program)

Mar. 2026 – Aug. 2026

Morningstar

Chicago, IL

- Shipped a production self-service AI pipeline platform on AWS with configurable ingestion, extraction, and multi-provider LLM support over PDF/HTML, enabling 2,000+ non-technical analysts across 5 global offices to build custom RAG workflows on 1,000+ financial documents.
- Cut financial data-collection turnaround from a 5-week JSON build-and-test cycle to under a minute; adopted by 2 teams now extending the platform, and endorsed by senior leadership as the foundation for a document tagging and search tool.
- Reduced rule authoring from 2 weeks to 2 minutes on a production data-validation engine governing financial data quality, refactoring the Vue frontend to cut duplicate code and load times and shipping a guided wizard over FastAPI/MySQL endpoints validated by golden datasets.

Software Engineering Intern

May 2024 – Sep. 2024

University of Illinois at Chicago

Chicago, IL

- Built the Python dependency-analysis engine for an enterprise Policy as Code compliance framework, parsing formal GDPR rule definitions to map inter-rule dependencies and expose ordering constraints for automated regulatory verification.
- Translated GDPR regulatory language into formal, machine-checkable specifications and documented rule semantics for the tooling used to audit PII-handling software.

Academic Tutor

Sep. 2024 – Present

University of Illinois at Chicago

Chicago, IL

- Tutor 50+ students per semester across 4 semesters in algorithms and quantitative coursework: Computer Algorithms (MCS 401), Data Structures (CS 251), Systems Programming (CS 361), Cryptography (CS 488), Machine Organization (CS 261), CS 111/141/151, and Calculus I–III (MATH 180/181/210).

PROJECTS

Algorithmic Trading Bot | Python, Docker, JSON

Apr. 2026 – Jun. 2026

- Built a live paper-trading bot on 15-minute bars, using Kelly Criterion position sizing and automated risk control to grow a \$10,000 simulated account to \$15,000 (~50% return) over 3 months of continuous operation.
- Developed fault-tolerant market-data streaming pipelines that recover from frozen ticks and API lease locks, sustaining 100% uptime within resource limits.

Interview Prep Bot | Python, Docker, Google Cloud Platform, GraphQL

Sep. 2025 – May 2026

- Engineered a full-stack Discord bot serving 100+ commands daily to developers preparing for technical interviews, integrating the LeetCode GraphQL API to serve 1,000+ unique programming challenges on demand.
- Containerized the application with a multi-stage Dockerfile and deployed to a Google Cloud VM, achieving 99.9% uptime across the academic year.

WikiVerify | n8n, OpenAI API, Firestore, Cloud Storage

Apr. 2026

- Designed a human-augmented AI pipeline that verifies Wikipedia citations against source documents, owning system architecture, requirements gathering, and the reviewer dashboard.
- Eliminated a token-per-minute rate-limit bottleneck by replacing LLM-based claim extraction with deterministic regex parsing, removing a per-claim API call from the critical path.

Content Creator Analytics Platform (SparkHacks '26) | TypeScript, React, Express, Firebase

Feb. 2026

- Placed third at SparkHacks '26, architecting and deploying an end-to-end analytics platform in a 24-hour build, with Express/Firebase pipelines load-tested to 500+ concurrent users.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C/C++, Go, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frameworks/Libraries: FastAPI, React, Vue.js, Node.js, Express, Django, NumPy, Pandas

Cloud & Tools: AWS (S3, DynamoDB), Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Git, Bitbucket, Harness CI/CD, MySQL, Firebase, Firestore

AI & Systems: RAG pipelines, LLM API integration (OpenAI), AI-assisted development (Cursor, Claude Code, Codex), n8n, Policy as Code